THE SUDAN IMPACT ACT

United States–Sudan Agriculture and Minerals Partnership

An Analysis of the Proposed Legislation, Economic Opportunities, National Sovereignty, and Geopolitical Implications

Legislative Reference

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1. Introduction

The **Sudan Investing in Minerals, Partnership, Agriculture, Commerce, and Trade Act**, known as the **Sudan IMPACT Act**, is proposed United States legislation intended to establish an agriculture and minerals partnership between the United States and Sudan.

The bill was introduced by Representative Jim Baird on 13 October 2026 and referred to the House Committee on Foreign Affairs.

Its central proposal is to provide agricultural equipment, mining technology, technical expertise, and related assistance to Sudan in exchange for access to specified Sudanese natural resources.

However, the proposed partnership is conditional. The legislation requires the United States Secretary of State to determine that a legitimate, civilian-led Sudanese governing authority has made sufficient, measurable progress in civilian protection, political stability, and responsible resource governance.

Official legislative text:
Read H.R. 10795 on GovInfo
Sponsor's announcement:
Read Representative Baird's announcement

This document distinguishes the provisions of the introduced bill from potential economic consequences and questions that Sudanese policymakers and citizens may wish to examine.

2. What Does IMPACT Stand For?

IMPACT stands for:

Investing in Minerals, Partnership, Agriculture, Commerce, and Trade

The legislation proposes a United States–Sudan Agriculture and Minerals Partnership intended to expand economic engagement between the two countries.

The proposed arrangement connects two areas of potential cooperation:

- **United States contribution:** agricultural and mining equipment, technology, technical assistance, and relevant expertise.
- **Sudanese contribution:** specified natural resources mined or produced in Sudan, subject to the partnership's conditions and an agreement with appropriate representatives of a civilian-led Sudanese government.

The bill does not itself establish an operational exchange contract or specify a final financial valuation for the resources and assistance.

3. Principal Provisions

3.1 Agriculture and Food Production

The proposed agricultural component includes:

- Farm machinery and agricultural equipment.
- Precision agriculture technology.
- Irrigation technology.
- Agricultural processing equipment.
- Technical expertise relevant to agricultural production and supply chains.

For Sudan, the potential significance lies in the opportunity to improve agricultural productivity, food processing, irrigation efficiency, technical training, and the value added to agricultural products.

These benefits would depend on the actual equipment supplied, the terms of the partnership, local implementation capacity, and the extent to which Sudanese producers can access the technology.

3.2 Mining and Geological Technology

The proposed mining component includes:

- Mining equipment.
- Geological surveying technology and assistance.
- Mine safety technology.
- Environmental remediation technology.
- Supply-chain expertise.

Such assistance could support more efficient mineral extraction, better geological assessment, improved worker safety, and more effective environmental management.

Nevertheless, the legislation's introduction does not guarantee that these technologies will be supplied or that any particular economic outcome will follow.

4. Natural Resources Covered by the Bill

The bill defines the resources covered by the proposed partnership as follows:

LightBlue Resource	Potential strategic significance
Gold	Jewellery, investment, and industrial uses
Uranium	Nuclear fuel supply chains
Crude oil	Energy and petrochemical industries
Chromium	Metallurgy and stainless steel production
Iron	Steel and infrastructure development
Copper	Electrical equipment and industrial manufacturing
Manganese	Steelmaking and battery supply chains
Zinc	Galvanising and industrial applications
Silver	Electronics, jewellery, and industrial uses
Nickel	Stainless steel and battery technologies
Gum arabic	Food, pharmaceutical, and industrial applications

The list above follows the bill's definition of covered resources. It should not be interpreted as a statement that every listed resource is a mineral in the strict geological sense.
In particular, crude oil and gum arabic are different types of natural resources.
The bill does not establish a fixed quantity, price, or monetary value for any resource to be transferred.

5. Conditions for Establishing the Partnership

The proposed partnership is not unconditional.

Under Section 3 of H.R. 10795, the Secretary of State must determine that a legitimate, civilian-led governing authority in Sudan has taken sufficient steps to demonstrate measurable improvement in three areas.

1. **Civilian protection:** measurable improvement in the protection of civilians.
2. **Political stability:** sufficient progress toward greater political stability.
3. **Responsible resource governance:** improvements in the governance of the resources covered by the proposed partnership.

Following an affirmative determination, the partnership would operate subject to the agreement of appropriate counterparts of a civilian-led Government of Sudan and applicable United States legal authorities.

The precise implementation would therefore depend on the relevant determinations, agreements, and subsequent administrative action.

6. Potential Economic Implications for Sudan

6.1 Agricultural Development

If implemented effectively, the proposed partnership could help Sudan obtain agricultural machinery, irrigation technology, and processing equipment.

Possible benefits include:

- Increased agricultural productivity.
- Reduced post-harvest losses.
- Improved food processing and storage.
- Technical training for farmers and agricultural professionals.
- Development of domestic agricultural value chains.

The scale of these benefits would depend on access to equipment, affordability, infrastructure, maintenance, financing, and the needs of Sudanese farming communities.

6.2 Mineral Processing and Industrial Development

Mining technology and geological assistance could contribute to more effective resource assessment and mineral processing.

A key policy question is whether Sudan would receive technology and expertise that strengthen domestic capacity, rather than remaining dependent on the export of unprocessed natural resources.

A development-oriented arrangement could consider local processing, technical education, industrial partnerships, and opportunities for Sudanese engineers and researchers.

6.3 Employment and Skills

The partnership could create opportunities for training and employment if projects involve Sudanese workers, institutions, and enterprises.

The actual effects would depend on the contractual terms, procurement arrangements, investment levels, and local participation.

6.4 Public Revenue and Reconstruction

Natural-resource revenues can potentially support public services, infrastructure, education, healthcare, and economic reconstruction.

However, these outcomes are not automatic. They require transparent accounting, effective institutions, responsible public financial management, and mechanisms to ensure that public resources benefit Sudanese communities.

7. National Sovereignty and Resource Governance

The proposed exchange raises fundamental questions about Sudan's authority over its natural resources.

7.1 Who Negotiates on Behalf of Sudan?

A central issue is the legitimacy and accountability of the authority negotiating the partnership.

The bill explicitly makes the proposed arrangement dependent on progress toward civilian protection, political stability, and responsible resource governance.

For Sudan, the practical question is how the authority representing the country would be established, how its mandate would be recognised, and how the public interest would be protected.

7.2 Fair Valuation

Any eventual agreement would need to address the relative value of the resources supplied and the equipment, technology, and assistance received.

Relevant questions include:

- How would the value of the resources be calculated?
- Who would independently assess resource prices?
- How would equipment quality and delivery costs be evaluated?
- Would the agreement disclose quantities, prices, and payment or exchange terms?
- What independent mechanisms would verify compliance with the agreement?

These are questions for negotiating and evaluating a future agreement; the introduced bill does not supply a complete commercial valuation framework.

7.3 Transparency and Public Accountability

A transparent arrangement could include public disclosure of contracts, independent auditing, clear revenue reporting, and appropriate oversight.

Safeguards would also be needed to reduce the risks of corruption, conflicts of interest, environmental harm, and the concentration of resource benefits among a limited number of actors.

8. Does the Act Give the United States Sudan's Gold?

No automatic transfer of gold is established by the introduction of this bill.

Gold is one of the resources listed in H.R. 10795. However, the introduced legislation proposes a framework for a future partnership; it does not itself execute a resource-transfer agreement or grant immediate operational access to Sudanese gold.

The proposed partnership is subject to the required determination by the Secretary of State and agreement with appropriate representatives of a civilian-led Sudanese government.

It is therefore important to distinguish three stages:

1. **Legislative proposal:** the bill is introduced in Congress.
2. **Legal and administrative implementation:** the necessary conditions and authorities are satisfied.
3. **Commercial implementation:** an appropriate agreement establishes the actual terms of resource transfers and assistance.

The first stage does not, by itself, establish that the second or third stage has occurred.

9. Questions for Sudanese Citizens and Policymakers

The proposal merits examination through several policy questions.

1. **National sovereignty:** What legal and constitutional arrangements would authorise the negotiation and approval of resource agreements?
2. **Fair exchange:** Would the value of resources transferred be proportionate to the equipment, services, and technology received?
3. **Transparency:** Would the agreement, its valuations, and its public revenues be available for independent scrutiny?
4. **Local development:** Would Sudanese farmers, engineers, researchers, and industrial workers acquire lasting skills and productive capacity?
5. **Environmental protection:** What safeguards would govern mining operations, water use, land restoration, and environmental damage?
6. **Public benefit:** What arrangements would ensure that the benefits reach communities and support national reconstruction?
7. **Civilian governance:** How would progress in civilian protection, political stability, and responsible resource management be assessed and independently scrutinised?

These questions provide a framework for assessing the proposal without assuming that its intended benefits or possible risks have already materialised.

10. Geopolitical Significance

Sudan's natural resources, agricultural potential, and geographical position give the proposed partnership significance beyond a simple commercial exchange.

Its implications may be relevant to the wider relationships among Sudan, the United States, Egypt, the Gulf states, and countries connected to the Nile Basin and the Horn of Africa.

Several dimensions merit attention.

10.1 United States–Sudan Relations

The bill proposes a framework for economic engagement linked to measurable improvements in civilian protection, political stability, and resource governance.

Its eventual significance would depend on whether the legislation advances, how the required conditions are interpreted, and whether a partnership is subsequently negotiated and implemented.

10.2 Egypt and the Nile Basin

Sudan's agricultural development, economic recovery, and political stability have implications for its neighbours.

For Egypt and the wider Nile Basin, relevant issues include agricultural production, regional trade, infrastructure, water management, cross-border stability, and economic cooperation.

The bill itself does not establish a specific Nile Basin policy or determine how these regional relationships would change.

10.3 Gulf States and Other Economic Partners

Sudan's natural resources and agricultural potential may also be relevant to existing and prospective economic relationships with Gulf states and other international partners.

Any assessment should consider the terms of the proposed United States partnership alongside Sudan's other economic relationships, without assuming that cooperation with one partner necessarily excludes cooperation with others.

10.4 Regional Stability

The legislation expressly links the proposed partnership to improvements in civilian protection and political stability.

Whether economic engagement could contribute to broader stability would depend on implementation, institutional capacity, the distribution of benefits, and the wider political and security environment.

11. A Development-Oriented Framework for Sudan

A useful way to assess the proposed partnership is to consider whether it could strengthen Sudan's long-term productive capacity.

Five principles are particularly relevant.

1. **Sovereignty:** protect Sudan's lawful authority over its resources and the public interest.
2. **Transparency:** ensure clear contracts, credible valuations, independent auditing, and accountable revenue management.
3. **Technology transfer:** build domestic expertise in agriculture, geology, mining, engineering, and industrial processing.
4. **Environmental responsibility:** require appropriate safeguards, monitoring, and remediation.
5. **Inclusive development:** promote opportunities for Sudanese communities, workers, farmers, researchers, and enterprises.

These principles are proposed criteria for evaluating a future agreement. They should not be mistaken for a claim that every safeguard is expressly required by H.R. 10795.

12. Conclusion

The Sudan IMPACT Act proposes a United States–Sudan agriculture and minerals partnership that would exchange agricultural and mining equipment, technology, and assistance for access to specified Sudanese resources.

Its central conditions concern civilian protection, political stability, and responsible resource governance.

For Sudan, the principal policy question is how natural resources can contribute to sustainable development while protecting national sovereignty and the interests of Sudanese citizens.

Agricultural modernisation, geological technology, safer mining, mineral processing, technical education, and transparent public revenues could contribute to reconstruction if an eventual agreement is well designed and implemented.

However, the legislation's introduction does not guarantee these outcomes. The terms of any future agreement, the legitimacy and accountability of the negotiating authority, and the distribution of benefits would be decisive.

The central question for Sudan

How can Sudan transform its natural-resource wealth into productive capacity, scientific and technological development, public benefit, and sustainable prosperity while safeguarding its sovereignty and the interests of its people?

13. Official Sources and Further Reading

The following sources provide access to the introduced legislation and its official legislative context.

[1] Full text of H.R. 10795

United States Government Publishing Office, GovInfo.

Read the official bill text (HTML).

[2] Official PDF of H.R. 10795

United States Government Publishing Office, GovInfo.

Read or download the official bill (PDF).

[3] Congressional Record, 13 October 2026

Official record of bills introduced in the House of Representatives.

Consult the Congressional Record.

[4] Sponsor's announcement

Office of Representative Jim Baird, 13 October 2026.

Read the sponsor's announcement.

[5] Legislative record and status information

GovInfo legislative document record.

View the bill's official record.

Research note: This document analyses the version of H.R. 10795 introduced on 13 October 2026. Its legislative status and any subsequent amendments should be checked against the official record before using the document for formal policy, legal, or academic purposes.
The potential economic and geopolitical consequences discussed here are analytical considerations, not guaranteed outcomes or additional provisions of the bill.